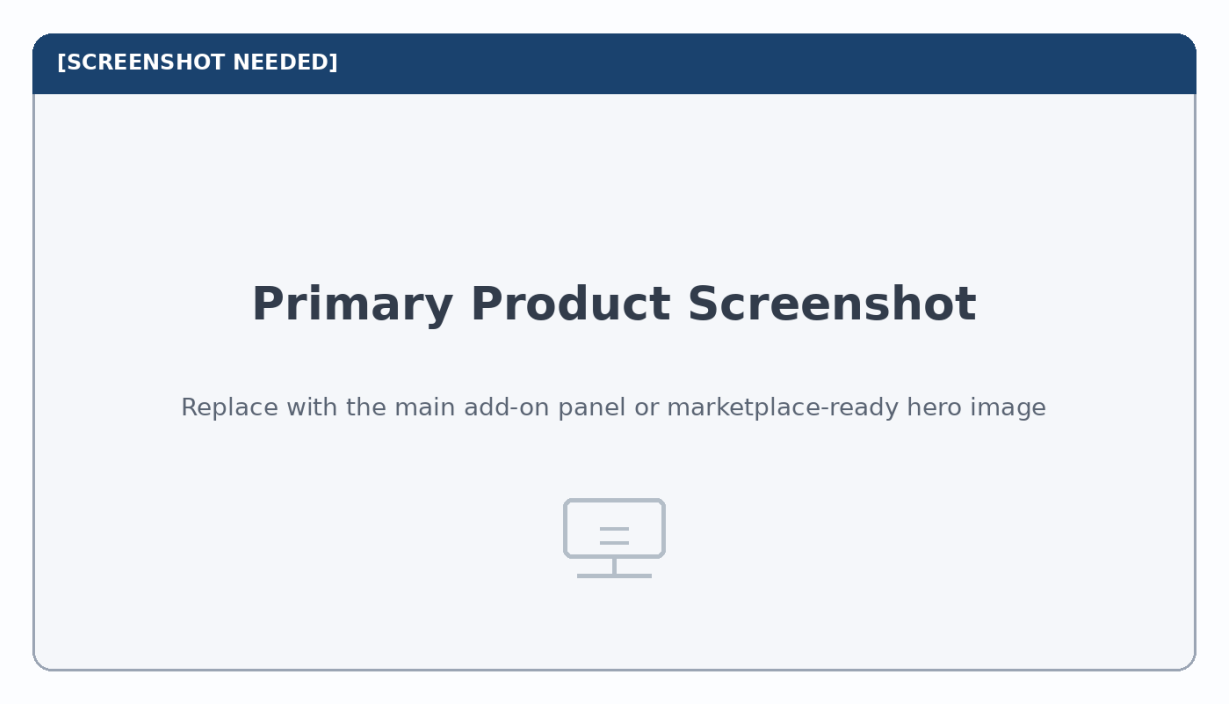
DRH - Add-ons Audit

Professional User Manual



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Copyright and Disclaimer

Important: Distribute this manual with the final commercial edition of the product and keep all licensing and attribution notices aligned with the published listing and support terms.

Topic	Statement
License	GNU General Public License v3 or later.
Copyright Holder	Paco Salas (Dr. Hacker - BH2K).
Warranty	Unless separately stated in writing, the software is provided without warranty.
Commercial Distribution	Commercial sale is permitted when distribution remains aligned with the applicable license terms.
Manual Legal Status	This manual is intended for user guidance and commercial product distribution.

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About This Manual

This guide explains how to install, enable, configure, and use DRH - Add-ons Audit inside Blender. It documents audit terminology, result states, comparison workflow, export options, and day-to-day operating procedures for individual users and production teams.

Conventions Used	Meaning
Bold UI labels	Product interface labels such as Refresh, Export, and Open Last Report.
Numbered steps	Action procedures that the user should perform in order.
Note / Tip / Warning / Important	Callout labels used to highlight operational details or cautions.
Important	Operational detail or caution that should be reviewed before continuing.
Figure	Illustration, interface view, or report example referenced in the guide.

> **Note: The add-on audits both the current Blender session and add-on folders discovered on disk. Those are related but not identical sources of truth.**

Product Overview

DRH - Add-ons Audit is a Blender system and pipeline utility designed to review installed Blender add-ons, compare duplicates, identify compatibility and metadata issues, preview findings in the 3D Viewport sidebar, and export audit data to multiple report formats.

The add-on presents two primary work modes: **Preview**, which scans add-ons and shows findings in the main review table, and **Snapshot**, which compares the current audit against a previous exported report.

> **Important: "Loaded Now" refers only to add-ons loaded in the current Blender session. Files discovered elsewhere on disk are inventory records and may not reflect live runtime state.**

Verified Capability	What It Does
Inventory scan	Scans loaded add-ons and add-on folders discovered across current, user-profile, and system installation paths.
Duplicate analysis	Identifies duplicate copies of the same add-on across distinct installation paths.
Conflict analysis	Flags version conflicts and distinguishes active, candidate, and shadowed copies.
Compatibility review	Compares declared minimum Blender version metadata against detected installation versions.
Metadata and structure review	Checks version presence, doc/tracker URLs, structure, parse errors, and missing __init__.py where relevant.
Update-support detection	Looks for built-in updater markers or classifies the add-on as manual/platform-managed where appropriate.
Report export	Exports audit or snapshot data to XLSX, CSV, TSV, JSON, XML, HTML, or Markdown.
Snapshot comparison	Loads a previous export file and reports Added, Removed, and Changed add-ons.

Key Features

Feature	Details
Preview tab	Primary audit workspace with actions, setup controls, summary metrics, filters, results table, and selected-row review.
Snapshot tab	Loads a previous export, computes differences, filters diff rows, and exports the comparison result.
Summary metrics	Shows ecosystem health, manual review count, incompatibilities, duplicates, conflicts, shadowed copies, loaded-now count, and installation totals.
Selectable result rows	Supports manual selection, Select All, Clear Selection, and the Selected export profile.
Column visibility and widths	Preview and Snapshot tables can hide/show columns and optionally use custom width weights.
Risk rules	Risk levels use configurable default rules plus fixed escalations for severe conditions such as broken structure or incompatible Blender versions.
Open actions	Can open the output folder, the last exported report, or the install folder for the active reviewed add-on.

System Requirements

Requirement	Verified Information
Blender	Minimum declared version: 4.2.0.
Maximum tested Blender version	Use the same Blender build planned for production deployment and validate in your environment.
Supported platforms	Windows, macOS, and Linux.
Dependencies	No separate third-party dependency installation is required for standard use.
Bundled binaries	None required for standard use.
Filesystem access	Required. The add-on scans add-on directories and writes export files.
Internet access	Not required for the core local audit and export workflow.
Disk space / memory	Standard Blender workstation resources are sufficient for typical audit and export workflows.

Compatibility

Area	Compatibility Notes
Product	Designed for Blender 4.2.0 and later.
Add-ons being audited	Compatibility state is computed from metadata such as minimum Blender version, not from launching each add-on.
Export comparison input	Previous exports can be loaded from .xlsx, .json, .csv, .tsv, .xml, .html, or .md.
Installation discovery	Current, user-profile, and system installation roots are probed using platform-specific path logic.

> **Warning: A Compatible result means the declared minimum Blender version is satisfied by the detected installation version. It does not guarantee that the add-on is fully functional in every production scene or environment.**

Included Components

Component	Purpose
Main Interface	Primary workspace in the 3D Viewport sidebar for Preview and Snapshot operations.
Preferences	Persistent defaults for export behavior, columns, and operational settings.
Scan Engine	Collects installed add-on information and evaluates review states.
Export Engine	Writes audit reports in the supported output formats.
Snapshot Comparison	Loads an earlier report and compares it against the current audit.
Selection and Filters	Lets users narrow the review set by state, category, search term, and sort order.

Component	Purpose
Detail Review	Shows compatibility, duplicate/shadow status, paths, and metadata for the active row.
Runtime Properties	Stores panel state, filters, and workflow choices during the session.
Registration Layer	Initializes product classes and Blender integration.
Report Profiles	Controls how much detail is included for review, sharing, or archive output.

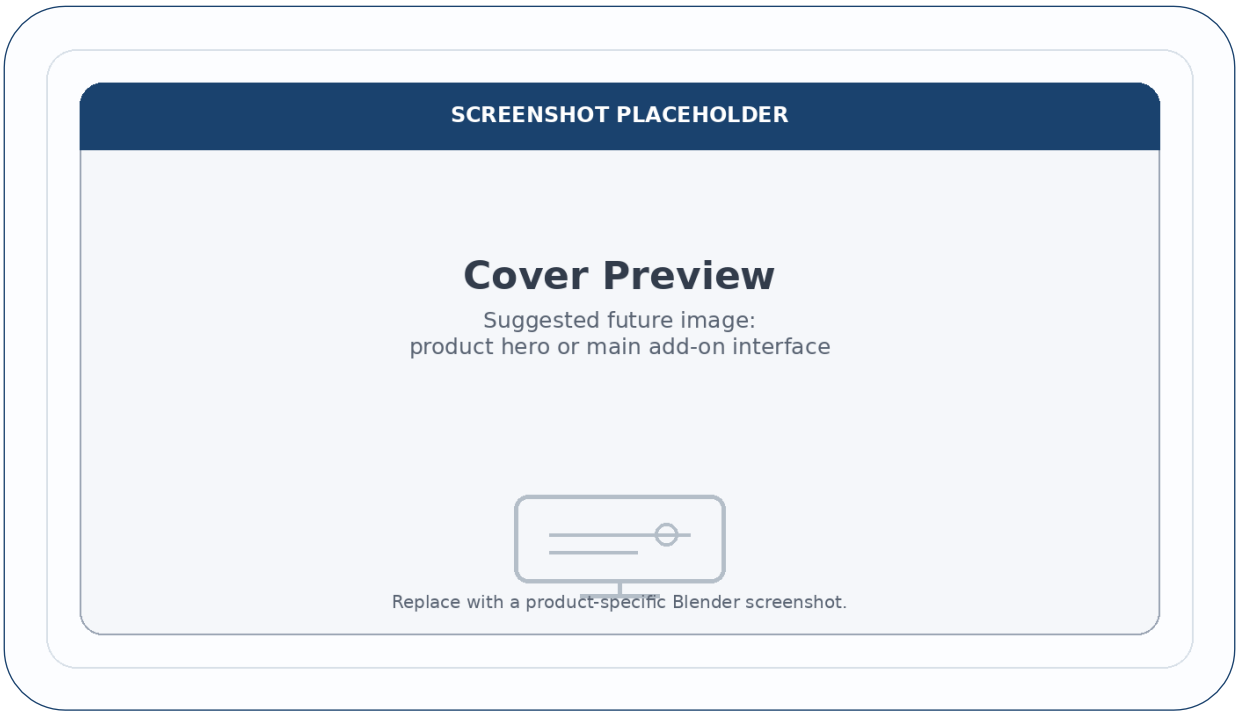
Installation

Prerequisites

1. Confirm that your Blender installation is version 4.2.0 or later.
2. Keep the installation file available locally if you plan to install from disk.
3. Make sure you have permission to write to your Blender user configuration and add-on directories.
4. Close and reopen Blender after installation if the add-on does not appear immediately.

Install from Disk in Blender Preferences

1. Open Blender.
2. Go to Edit > Preferences > Add-ons.
3. Use Install from Disk... and browse to the delivered add-on installation file.
4. Confirm the installation.
5. Enable DRH - Add-ons Audit in the add-on list.
6. Open a 3D Viewport and expand the Sidebar (N-panel) if it is not visible.
7. Select the DRH - Add-ons Audit tab.



Note: After installation, the panel is available in 3D Viewport > Sidebar > DRH - Add-ons Audit.

Install through Blender Extensions

1. Use your standard Blender Extensions workflow to add and enable the product.
2. After installation, confirm that the add-on is enabled.
3. Open the 3D Viewport sidebar and verify that the DRH - Add-ons Audit tab is available.

> **Important: Validate menu wording and visual assets against the exact Blender release used for publication.**

First Launch and Verification

1. Open the DRH - Add-ons Audit tab in the 3D Viewport sidebar.
2. Click Refresh.
3. Confirm that the Summary section populates and that the Results table shows preview rows.
4. Optionally open Panel Settings to review export defaults, visible columns, and risk rules.

Update, Reinstall, and Uninstall

Task	Recommended Procedure
Update	Install the newer version using the same Blender installation workflow, then confirm the add-on is enabled and run Refresh again.
Reinstall	Disable the add-on, remove the current installation if required by your deployment method, then install the product again and enable it.
Uninstall	Disable the add-on in Blender Preferences and remove the installed product according to your Blender add-on or Extensions workflow.
Preserve exports	Exported reports are written to the configured output folder and are not automatically removed by the add-on.

Common Installation Problems

Issue	Likely Cause	Resolution
The tab does not appear	The add-on is not enabled or Blender needs a restart.	Enable the add-on in Preferences and reopen Blender if necessary.
Refresh fails immediately	Runtime or installation state is incomplete.	Restart Blender, confirm the product is installed correctly, and try Refresh again.
The product installs but no rows appear	No scan has been run yet or filters hide the result set.	Click Refresh and reset filters in the panel or Panel Settings.
Extensions workflow text differs	Blender build/UI wording differs from the build used for this manual.	Update the manual screenshots and wording for the exact Blender release used for distribution.

Activation, Licensing, and Initial Setup

Area	Verified Status
Activation	No activation step is required.
License model	GPL-3.0-or-later.
Commercial support terms	Commercial support terms depend on the publisher channel used for

Area	Verified Status
	distribution.
Initial setup tasks	Choose export format/profile, output folder, report name, and optional advanced settings.

Add-on Preferences and Settings

The add-on exposes saved defaults in Blender Preferences and live settings in the panel itself. The preferences screen is intended for persistent defaults; the panel and Panel Settings popup are intended for current-session operation.

Blender Preferences > Add-ons

Preferences Section	Purpose
General Defaults	Stores the default export format, export profile, output folder, report name, default state filter, and default sort order.
Snapshot Defaults	Stores default snapshot export format, snapshot profile, snapshot output folder, and snapshot report name.
Preview Table	Controls which preview columns are visible and, if enabled, custom width weights.
Snapshot Table	Controls visible snapshot columns and snapshot column width weights.
Risk Rules	Lets you map the built-in risk issue flags to High, Medium, or Low defaults.
Reset Defaults	Restores saved defaults and updates the live N-panel state.

Runtime Panel Settings

Setting	Description
Format	Current export format for the main audit report.
Profile	Current export profile for the main audit report.
Output Folder	Directory used for exported reports.
Report Name	Base name used when building timestamped report filenames.
Snapshot Format / Profile / Output Folder / Report Name	Equivalent settings for snapshot comparison exports.
Only Enabled Add-ons	Restricts the visible result set to loaded add-ons only.
Sanitize Paths	Masks user-home portions of exported installation paths.
Open After Export	Attempts to open the exported file automatically after a successful export.
Show Advanced Options	Expands advanced controls in the Setup section.

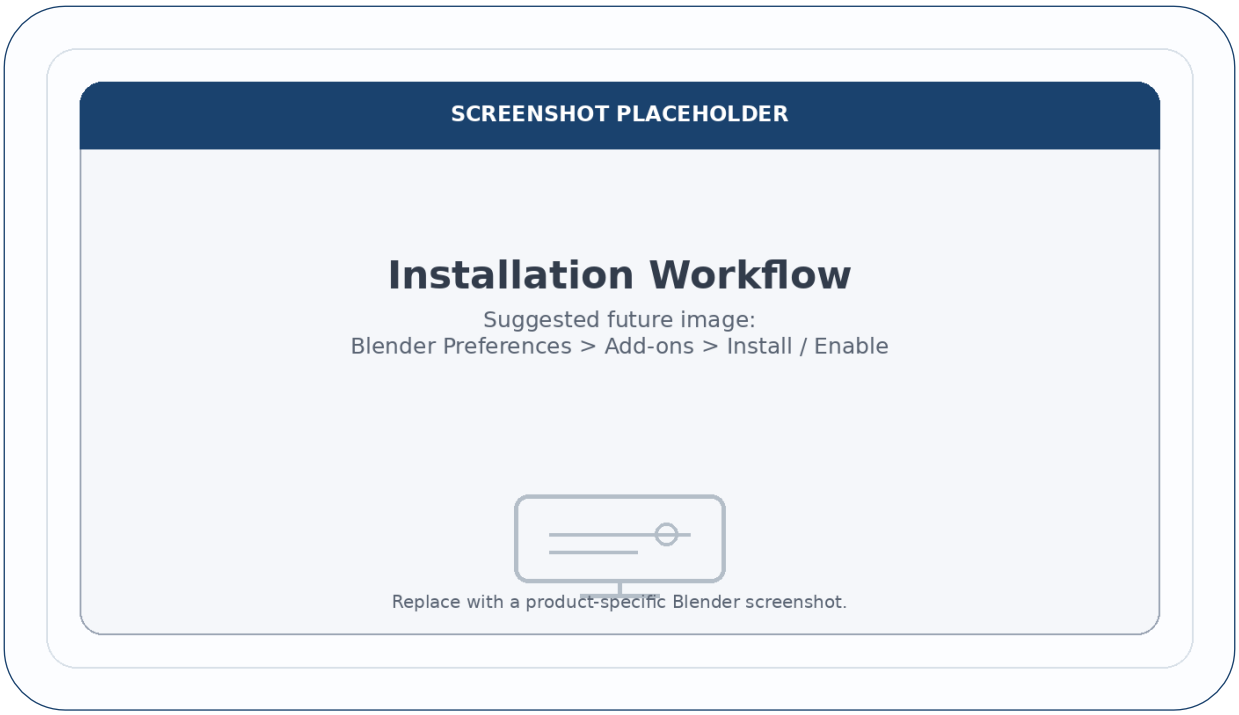
Default Risk Rules

The add-on stores risk settings for the following built-in issue keys:

Default Risk Band	Issue Keys in the Default Rules

Default Risk Band	Issue Keys in the Default Rules
High	Warning, Incompatible Blender, Custom Path
Medium	Missing Version, Missing __init__.py
Low	Missing Doc URL, Missing Tracker URL

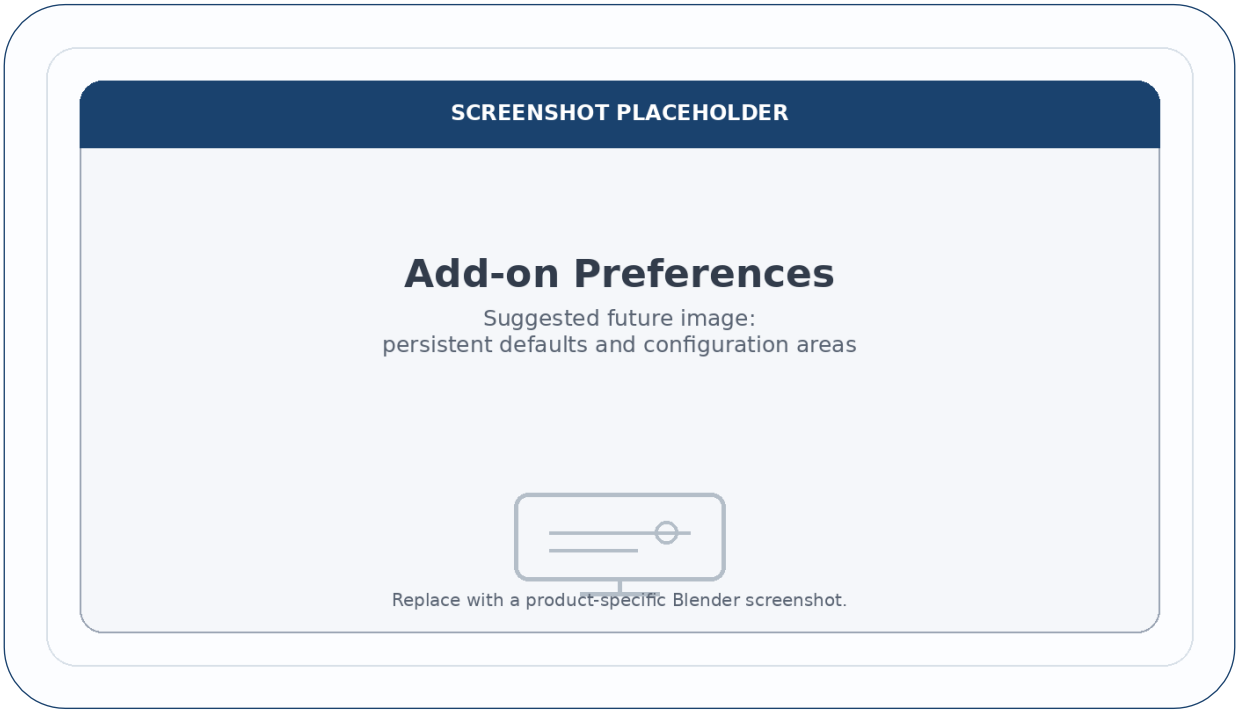
> **Important: The final risk level can still be escalated by hard-coded conditions. Broken structure and incompatible Blender force HIGH. Version conflict, shadowed copies, and invalid metadata force at least MEDIUM.**



Interface Overview

The add-on lives in the 3D Viewport Sidebar under the category **DRH - Add-ons Audit**. The panel uses a tab bar with two tabs: **Preview** and **Snapshot**.

Area	What It Contains
Preview tab	Actions, Setup, Summary, Results, filters, row selection, and Selected Add-on Review.
Snapshot tab	Snapshot Setup, Load Snapshot, diff filters, comparison summary, and snapshot export actions.
Panel header preset button	Opens the Panel Settings popup.
Selected Add-on Review	Shows additional details for the active row, including compatibility, duplicate/shadow state, update support, metadata, structure, source root, and install type.



Main Panels, Menus, and Controls

Preview Actions

Control	Function
Refresh	Scans installed add-ons and refreshes the preview.
Export	Exports the current audit report or selected rows only, depending on profile.
Open Output Folder	Opens the current export directory.
Open Last Report	Opens the most recently exported file.

Preview Setup

Field	Purpose
Format	Selects the export file type.
Profile	Selects the export column set.
Output Folder	Selects the target directory for exports.
Report Name	Provides the base export filename stem.
Advanced Options	Reveals Only Enabled Add-ons, Sanitize Paths, and Open After Export.

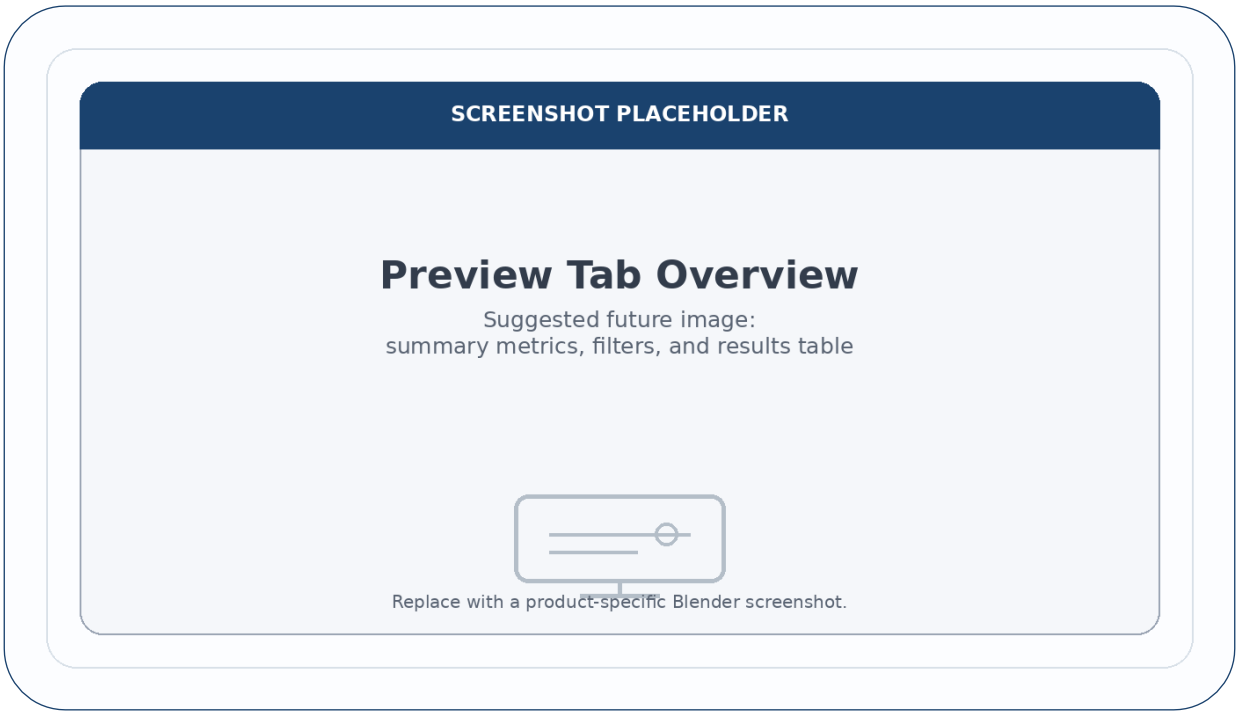
Preview Filters and Result Table

Control	Purpose
Search	Searches visible rows across add-on name, module, author, version, kind, installation, category, issues, and suggested action.
State	Filters by All, Loaded Now, or Not Loaded.
Review	Filters by review state such as Broken, Duplicates, Conflicts, Incompatible,

Control	Purpose
	Selected, Shadowed, and more.
Sort	Sorts by action, author, category, compatibility, load state, duplicate, installation, kind, module, name, risk, shadow, update, or version.
Category	Filters by normalized Blender add-on category.
Select All / Clear Selection	Selects or clears all currently visible rows.

Selected Add-on Review

Displayed Value	Notes
Module / Version / Installation / Kind / Category	Core identity and installation metadata for the active result row.
Newest Safe	The newest safe version determined across duplicate candidates.
Duplicate / Conflict / Shadowed	Status derived from duplicate grouping and version comparison.
Compatibility / Update / Maintenance	Operational review values computed from metadata and source inspection.
Metadata / Structure / Origin / Source Root / Install Type	Diagnostic fields for source interpretation and quality.
Open Folder	Opens the install folder for the active reviewed add-on when a valid path is available.



Snapshot Controls

Control	Function
Snapshot Format / Profile /	Defines how snapshot diff exports will be written.

Control	Function
Output Folder / Report Name	
Load Snapshot	Loads a previous exported report for comparison.
Search / Filter / Sort	Filters diff rows by text and change type and sorts them.
Export Snapshot Report	Exports the comparison rows only.
Open Last Report	Opens the most recent export.
Clear	Clears the currently loaded snapshot and diff view.

Core Workflows

Workflow 1: Perform a Basic Add-on Audit

1. Open the Preview tab.
2. Click Refresh.
3. Review the Summary metrics to understand ecosystem health, duplicates, conflicts, shadowed copies, and incompatible add-ons.
4. Use the Search, State, Review, Sort, and Category filters to narrow the result set.
5. Click a row to inspect Selected Add-on Review details.

Workflow 2: Export the Current Audit

1. In Setup, choose the desired Format.
2. Choose the appropriate Profile for the intended audience.
3. Confirm the Output Folder and Report Name.
4. If you want privacy-friendly exports, enable Sanitize Paths.
5. Click Export.
6. Use Open Last Report or Open Output Folder to verify the result.

> **Tip: Report filenames are generated with a `DRH-` prefix, a sanitized file stem, and a timestamp. Snapshot exports use a separate snapshot stem.**

Workflow 3: Export Only Selected Rows

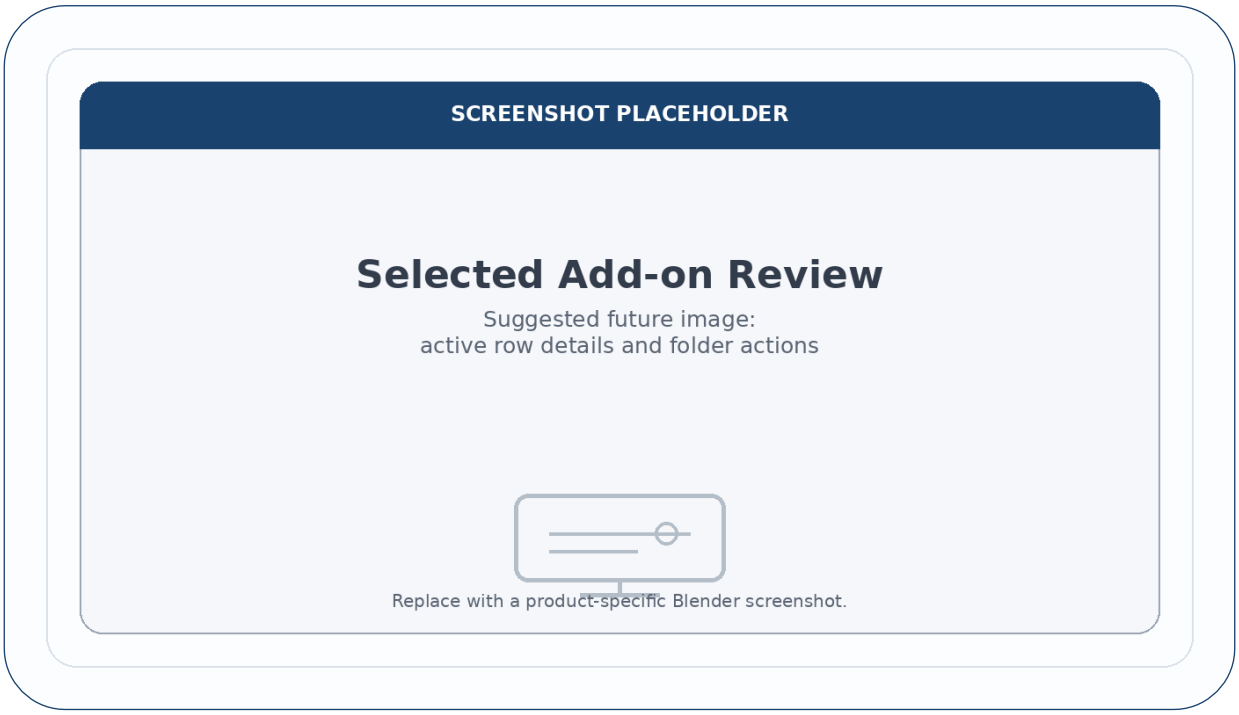
1. Filter the Preview results if needed.
2. Select one or more rows, or use Select All.
3. Set Profile to Selected.
4. Click Export.

> **Important: If the Selected profile is active and no rows are selected, the add-on reports: "No selected add-ons."**

Workflow 4: Compare Against a Previous Snapshot

1. Create an audit export or use an existing export supported by the compare loader.
2. Open the Snapshot tab.
3. Click Load Snapshot and choose a previous export file.

4. Review the comparison summary showing Added, Removed, Changed, and Total diff counts.
5. Use snapshot search or change-type filters to narrow the diff results.
6. Export the snapshot report if needed.



Step-by-Step Usage Instructions

1. Refresh the Preview

Use **Refresh** whenever you need the add-on to rescan the current Blender session and detected add-on directories.

> **Note: The refresh workflow updates the stored scan payload, visible preview rows, summary metrics, and snapshot diff view when a comparison file is already loaded.**

2. Interpret Summary Metrics

Metric	Meaning
Health	Average health score across reviewed rows.
Manual Review	Rows that need inspection because structure is broken, metadata is invalid/partial, or compatibility is unknown.
Incompatible	Rows whose declared minimum Blender version exceeds the detected installation version.
Update Support	Rows where update support was detected.
Conflicts	Rows involved in version conflicts across duplicate copies.
Duplicates	Rows where multiple copies were found.
Shadowed	Rows marked as shadowed copies in duplicate groups.
Loaded Now	Rows loaded in the current Blender session.
Installations	Distinct installation records represented in the audit.

Metric	Meaning
Extensions / Legacy	Rows grouped by detected add-on kind.

3. Review Row States

State	Operational Meaning
Duplicate = Duplicate	More than one distinct installation path was found for the same add-on identity.
Conflict = Version Conflict	Duplicate copies were found and they do not all share the same version.
Shadow = Active	The row is the active loaded copy or the primary selected copy.
Shadow = Candidate	The row is a non-active but strong candidate copy, usually the newest safe option.
Shadow = Shadowed	The row is an extra copy that is neither active nor the preferred candidate.
Compatibility = Unknown	Minimum Blender metadata or installation version could not be determined.
Update Support = Platform Managed	The audited add-on appears to rely on Blender's extension platform for updates.
Maintenance = Likely Maintained	The file appears relatively recent and includes URLs and version data.

4. Open Supporting Paths

1. To open the export directory, click Open Output Folder.
2. To open the last written file, click Open Last Report.
3. To inspect the active add-on on disk, select a row and click Open Folder in Selected Add-on Review.

> **Warning: Open-path behavior depends on the operating system. On Linux, a file opener such as `xdg-open` or `gio` may be required.**

Import, Export, Output, and Profiles

Supported Export Formats

Format	Use Case
XLSX	Native Excel workbook for tabular review and spreadsheet workflows.
CSV	Simple comma-separated exchange for scripts and spreadsheet tools.
TSV	Tab-separated export where commas in text are undesirable.
JSON	Structured export for automation and later comparison.
XML	Structured export for systems that prefer XML interchange.
HTML	Readable browser-based report for review, sharing, and archive use.
Markdown	Portable text report suitable for documentation repositories and issue trackers.

Supported Snapshot Import Formats

The comparison loader accepts previous exports in the following file types:

Accepted File Type	Notes
.xlsx	Parsed as a workbook snapshot.
.json	Accepts a list of rows or a payload object containing rows.
.csv / .tsv	Parsed using delimited column headers.
.xml	Parses `<addon>` nodes from the document.
.html	Parses exported inventory tables from HTML reports.
.md	Parses Markdown inventory tables.

Export Profiles

Profile	Description	Typical Use
Audit	Operational audit profile.	General review and support handoff.
Basic	Compact audit set.	Fast at-a-glance reporting.
Compatibility	Compatibility and metadata review.	Version-migration or upgrade checks.
Full	All available columns.	Deep technical review or archival export.
Inventory	Inventory and installation profile.	Path and installation tracking.
Operations	Conflict and audit profile.	Duplicate/version conflict cleanup.
Security	Conflict and safety review profile.	Path/operator/hotkey conflict review.
Selected	Export selected rows only.	Focused report on chosen items.
Summary	Executive audit summary.	High-level management/reporting view.

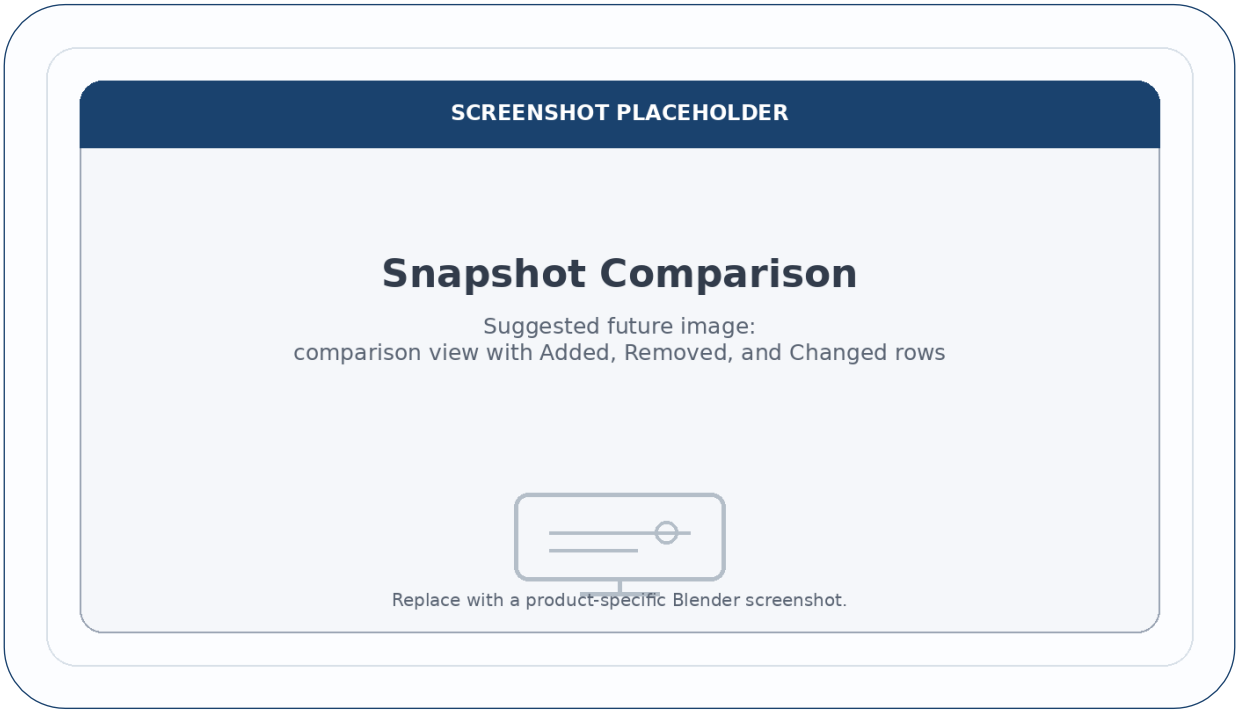
Snapshot Profiles

Snapshot Profile	Columns Included
Basic	Type and Add-on
Standard	Type, Add-on, and Module
Full	Type, Add-on, Module, and Details

Output Naming Behavior

Reports are saved with a standardized DRH-based filename that includes the report name and a timestamp, making exports easier to identify and archive.

> **Note: If the report name contains unsupported filename characters, they are normalized automatically.**



Examples and Common Use Cases

Use Case	How the Add-on Helps
Pre-upgrade audit	Filter for compatibility and legacy status before moving a workstation or studio to a newer Blender version.
Duplicate cleanup	Sort by Duplicate, inspect Shadow and Conflict states, and review install folders.
Extension migration	Identify legacy add-ons that may need extension-style packaging review.
Support triage	Export a Full or Audit profile to share the user's add-on environment with support or pipeline staff.
Baseline comparison	Export a report, then later load it as a snapshot to see what changed.

Tips and Best Practices

- Run a fresh Preview scan before exporting a report that will be shared or archived.
- Use the Selected profile for focused troubleshooting exports instead of sending the full add-on environment every time.
- Turn on Sanitize Paths before exporting outside your organization if user-home paths should not be exposed.
- When investigating duplicates, compare Duplicate, Conflict, Shadow, and Newest Safe together rather than in isolation.
- Treat Compatibility = Unknown as a review item, not a pass result.
- Capture and archive an HTML or JSON export before large Blender or pipeline changes so you have a comparison baseline later.

Troubleshooting

Symptom or Message	Probable Cause	Recommended Action
No preview rows. Use Refresh to	The scan has not been run	Click Refresh in the Preview tab.

Symptom or Message	Probable Cause	Recommended Action
scan installed add-ons.	yet.	
Preview refreshed, but expected items are missing.	Filters, Only Enabled Add-ons, or category/review filters are hiding rows.	Reset or relax filters and refresh again.
No selected add-ons.	Profile is set to Selected but no visible rows are selected.	Select rows first or switch to another export profile.
No snapshot loaded.	Snapshot export was requested without loading a comparison file.	Load a supported previous export in the Snapshot tab.
Comparison failed: …	The selected file is unsupported, malformed, or too large.	Use a supported export file created by the add-on and keep the input below the supported size limit.
Selected file exceeds the supported size limit (64 MiB).	Snapshot input file is too large.	Reduce file size, split the dataset, or use a smaller export format.
XML snapshot is malformed.	The XML file cannot be parsed.	Load a clean XML export from the add-on instead of a hand-edited file.
Could not open folder / file.	OS shell integration is unavailable or blocked.	Open the path manually or install a supported file opener on Linux.
Install path is not available.	The recorded add-on path no longer exists.	Rescan, verify the add-on is still installed, and check whether the row points to a stale location.

Known Limitations

- "Loaded Now" represents the current Blender session only; it cannot confirm whether filesystem-only copies are active at runtime.
- Compatibility is based on declared metadata and installation version detection, not on executing every add-on.
- Unknown compatibility results occur when minimum Blender metadata or installation version information cannot be determined.
- Snapshot comparison supports only the documented export file types and enforces input safety limits such as a 64 MiB file-size limit.
- Large snapshots are subject to row-count and workbook safety limits in the comparison loader.

FAQ

Question	Answer
Where do I find the add-on after installation?	In the 3D Viewport Sidebar (N-panel) under DRH - Add-ons Audit.
Does the add-on only look at loaded add-ons?	No. It audits loaded add-ons and also inventories add-on folders discovered on disk.
Can it compare against an older report?	Yes. The Snapshot tab can load previous exports in several supported formats.
Can I export to Excel?	Yes. XLSX is a supported export format.

Question	Answer
Can I hide columns I do not need?	Yes. Preview and Snapshot columns can be shown/hidden, and custom widths can be enabled.
Does it include license activation?	No. The product is ready to use after installation.
Does it change installed add-ons?	No. The workflow is focused on scanning, reviewing, opening paths, and exporting reports.
Does Compatibility = Compatible mean the add-on is fully safe to use?	No. It only means the detected installation version satisfies the declared minimum Blender version metadata.

Support, Contact, and Updates

Item	Current Status
Website / Listing	Use the official product listing or publisher profile.
Support	Use the support contact published with the sales channel.
Issue Reporting	Use the publisher support route associated with the listing.
Release Notes / Updates	Publish update notes through the product listing or release communication channel.
Commercial Support Scope	Define response times and service scope in the seller or publisher support policy.

Legal, Disclaimer, and Credits

Area	Text
Credits	Product author: Paco Salas (Dr. Hacker - BH2K).
License Notice	Distributed under GPL-3.0-or-later.
Warranty Notice	Unless separately stated in writing, the software is provided without warranty.
Trademark Acknowledgement	Blender is a trademark of the Blender Foundation. Any marketplace trademarks remain the property of their respective owners.
Third-Party Dependencies	No separate third-party dependencies are required for standard use.
Distribution Notice	Keep product listing details, support terms, and legal notices aligned across all sales channels.

Appendix A – Glossary

Term	Definition in This Manual
Loaded Now	The add-on is loaded in the current Blender session.
Duplicate	More than one distinct installation path exists for the same add-on identity.
Shadowed	An extra duplicate copy that is not the active or preferred candidate copy.
Candidate	A non-active duplicate copy identified as a likely preferred version, often because it is the newest safe choice.

Term	Definition in This Manual
Snapshot	A previously exported report used as a baseline for comparison.
Risk Level	A final classification such as HIGH, MEDIUM, LOW, or - based on issue rules and fixed escalations.
Sanitize Paths	Masks home-directory segments in exported installation paths.
Newest Safe Version	The latest non-incompatible candidate version chosen within a duplicate group.

Appendix B – Keyboard Shortcuts and Automation Notes

Topic	Note
Custom shortcuts	None documented for controlling the add-on itself.
Hotkey conflict auditing	The add-on records detectable hotkey conflicts and can include them in relevant export profiles.
Operator conflict auditing	The add-on records detectable operator ownership conflicts and can include them in security-oriented exports.